

rather than negative ones. The content may inspire the audience, or enlighten or teach them about something or it could simply entertain and appeal to their sense of amusement. Such types of content help the audience associate the brand with positivity. The idea of positive stories attracting people is evident in person-to-person interactions too. After all, who likes to hang out with someone who continually speaks about negative things? The same principle applies in social media as well.

Where it worked:

No brand probably does motivating its audience better than Nike. The brand has as long a tradition of coming out with inspiring campaigns as it has of sponsoring personalities from just about any sport that you can imagine. The year, 2012 was no different for the brand-as far as rolling out inspiring campaigns went. The #makeitcount campaign, which came out in time for the Olympics that year is a case in point. However, Nike wasn't an official sponsor of the event. What the brand did with the campaign was to encourage the audience to use the hashtag to relate their goals for the year to the world.

6. Embed a sense of urgency

Instant gratification is the name of the game when it comes to closing a sales in the hyper-commercial world that we inhabit. But there will always be an element of 'caution' in the customer's mind while they approach a brand's offer-caution not necessarily in a drastic sense, it could simply be exercising caution not to overspend. This flimsy barrier can easily be overcome though(at least, most times) provided your offer is compelling and you manage to create a sense of urgency around it.



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